the United States, and India is a valued partner in that. So, there's a lot happening on that front also.

Q: Secretary Rubio, how do you see the Quad evolving in response to China's growing assertiveness? And what more can India and the United States do together to secure critical supply chains and reduce their dependence on China?

Rubio: The first meeting I ever did as Secretary of State was a Quad meeting. We've had more Quad meetings in the last year and a half than probably the previous four years combined at the foreign ministry level. And we are going to have a leaders' level meeting now very shortly, probably in December, and we will try to arrange even more before the end of President Trump's term. He's got two and a half years left. So, this is a very important relationship, but it's important not just because we have four countries that are coordinating with one another. We're beginning to see outcomes. We're beginning to see results. As an example, maritime awareness, the ability to know what's happening underwater, threatening cables and so forth. This is something the Quad is working together on, and real things are happening. We can have the same when it comes to supply chains at large. The one thing I think is a consistent theme across the world, but certainly in the US-India relationship, is we do not want to be overly dependent on any country in the world. I am not singling out China. I'm saying any country in the world. We don't want to depend on any single country in the world for 90 per cent of anything that's critical to our economies, and we have to have the domestic capacity to do certain things

"President Donald Trump and PM Narendra Modi are dear friends; it works well because of that, because they see eye to eye on moving the ball forward, on getting things done"
— GOR

for ourselves. That's an interest India has. That's certainly an interest the United States has under President Trump, and that's something we can work together on. And that is, where we can create domestic capabilities in a mutually beneficial way for both countries on various key sectors, be it artificial intelligence or technology, biomedicine or pharmaceuticals, or critical minerals...the list goes on.

Q: India recently joined Pax Silica. Can we expect significant American investments and technology partnerships that would help India emerge as a key hub in strategic supply chains?

Gor: It's a great partnership. India was one of the first 10 countries that the United States invited to join Pax Silica because we trust India. They're a valued partner in this supply chain. It is the reason that the Secretary is here twice in one year. I am determined to bring the highest levels of our government here so they can talk to the highest levels of your government here and identify those opportunities. In three weeks, we have the attorney general coming here to work with the folks in Delhi. We're going to have a counter-narcotics conference in the capital. We're bringing our DEA administrator. To me, it is important to have the highest levels of our government engaged with individuals here in India.

"Tarang Shakti was the first time F-35s were in India for a joint exercise. Our F-35s don't go to any nation, they go to nations and partners we trust. India's a very valuable partner to us in the Quad"
— GOR



LEADER TO LEADER
PM Narendra Modi with President Donald Trump on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in France, Jun. 17